

BERNERA NEWS

By the community, for the community
in association with 

WHAT'S ON

FILM CLUB.

A new film club has been set up by Callum Macaulay and the BCA. Membership to the club is £5 a year, which gives free admission to all films. The first of this year's 'Movie Night's kicked off on the 24th of February with tasty hot snacks, drinks and popcorn (thanks to Catherine and Glynis); followed by the screening of the new Elvis film - rated 5 stars by the Guardian and described as "a blistering, turbocharged chronicle of the King". It was a great night and we look forward to the next one.

REGULARS

Bernera Community Centre Shop. Open Monday - Friday, 12-4pm. The shop is well stocked and run by volunteers. Cash or debit/credit cards accepted.

Winter Cafe open Tuesdays 12-3pm (in the Community Centre). Lunches, hot drinks and home baking (take away available).

Soup Stop on Thursdays 12-2pm until 4th May (in the Community Centre Cafe, come along for a free soup, hot drinks and a blether – all welcome).

Forage Croft Honesty Shop, Kirkibost. Open 24/7. Sells Eggs, bread, Scottish produce, sweets and some essential items.

WEEKLY CLUBS & CLASSES

All Sorts Club meet every Wednesday for social, games and chat, 2-4pm in the Dance Hall, £2. (for more details call Colin Halliday on 01851 612489).

Yoga Class on Wednesdays 6.30-7.30pm, £5
(for more details call Victoria on 07912 292 816/ or email victoria.evans05@hotmail.co.uk)

Sewing Session meets every Thursday, 6.30 - 8.30pm in the Dance Hall (free)
(for more details call Virginia 07460 467 721 or Julia 07894 516 609)

Carpet Bowls, Tuesdays and Thursdays, 2-4pm in the Main Hall, £2
(for more details call Irene Sutherland 01851 612269 or Colin Halliday on 01851 612489).

Badminton on Thursdays 7.30-9.30pm in the Main Hall, £2.50
(for more details call Careen 07944 216627)

Zumba on Mondays, 7.30-9.30pm in the Dance Hall, £2.50
(for more details call Careen on 07944 216627)

KIRKIBOST COMMON GRAZINGS MEETING - 1 APRIL

There will be a meeting on Saturday 1st April at 3pm in the dance studio at the hall for anyone interested in the Kirkibost Common Grazings. It's a meeting to explore what work needs to be done to reinstate the committee and to support its work. It is not a regulatory meeting and no official actions will be taken.

AM I TOO OLD FOR YOGA?

Some of you may have noticed that a yoga group has started at the Bernera Community Hall. Led by Victoria Rudge, a few of us unfold ourselves on yoga mats and do whatever our body allows us. I have been going along on Wednesday evenings and finding myself enjoying an activity I had always convinced myself not to like.

The truth is you can do yoga at any age, as long as you pick the type of yoga that suits you and your health considerations, etc.

What can yoga do for you? It will keep you flexible and build strength through low-impact moves. That's important, because each year that we don't exercise regularly, we lose around half a pound (about 0.23 kgs) of muscle.



How does yoga work? By maintaining certain poses, you strengthen different parts of your body. For example, standing poses like Warrior II help with bone density and lower body strength. Other poses like The Tree improve balance which helps to prevent falls. And if you find yourself wobbling a bit in the beginning (remember how easy it was to stand on one leg as a child!), you can hold onto something or lean against a wall for support.

Yoga doesn't have to be done on the floor either – you could try chair yoga, if floor poses aren't your thing. Chair yoga uses gentle movements that help stretch the body making it more flexible. You can still work on your balance by changing your centre of gravity in a chair by leaning forward and back or to the side.

Finally, yoga allows us to make simple changes to our activity levels which make huge differences to our health and well-being.

Virginia Allum
Earshader



THE CROFTING COMMISSION IS RECRUITING!

We are currently recruiting Crofting Area Representatives, formerly known as Crofting Assessors.

We are looking for enthusiastic volunteers from within the crofting counties to act as a valued link between the Commission and local crofting communities. Full training and support will be provided to help support crofting in your area.

Please apply via our website at www.crofting.scotland.gov.uk



GREAT BERNERA
– Community Development Trust –

TSI Western Isles Funding Award



The Trust are delighted to announce that in January funding was secured from TSI Western Isles mental well-being fund to help to improve social interaction and reduce social isolation in our community. Funds are being distributed to the Bernera Association and other Bernera community groups to provide or maintain activities that encourage meeting, making new friendships, relaxing, having fun with others, getting out and about and learning new skills.

Funding support to date includes the return of Movie Nights, and support towards future 'away trips' for members of the All Sorts Activities Club. This fund is for you, the community; so if there's an activity, event or skill you would like learn or share with others then please get in touch with the development Officers, Jo or Nat (jo@greatbernera.org / nat@greatbernera.org) and we can chat about how we can support you and others in the community.

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DTAS Funding aimed at helping to reduce the cost of living for Bernera residents

With the cost of food, fuel and electricity having skyrocketed, the GBCDT, BCA and other community groups have been looking at ways in which we can bring cost reductions to residents of Bernera. We are grateful for the funding received from DTAS which enables us to offer:

10% Community Shop Discount

Every Tuesday and Thursday, Bernera Community Shop will be offering a 10% discount off all products to all Bernera and Tir Mor residents. (This offers starts on the 7th March).

Complimentary 'Essentials Bags'

To help with the rising cost of living, beginning on the Friday the 17th of March, each fortnightly Friday we're giving away complimentary bags of essential household products (toiletries and cleaning products worth £20). The bags (one per household) will be distributed through **Bernera Community Shop (Breacleite)** and **Forage (22 Kirkibost)**. For more information, please keep your eye on the Great Bernera Community Development Trust Facebook page, BCA Bernera Community Association Facebook page or Croft 22 - Farm, Forage, Feast & Forest Facebook page, or just head over to the shops themselves. As we like to say ... every little helps :)

Discounted petrol and diesel prices at Bernera Fuel Pump

Since 2020, petrol and diesel prices have risen greatly. Living on Bernera, for many owning a car is a necessity and so to keep costs down, over the next few months the DTAS funding will help to subsidise fuel prices in Bernera to keep them in-line with Stornoway prices.

Support and Advice Session: At Home - Reducing Costs /Staying Warm**A date for your diary**

On the **16th March at the Community Hall 12-2PM**; TIG (Tighean Innse Gall) will be visiting Bernera to offer support and advice on a variety of home improvements, free services and products, aimed at reducing heating bills and keeping your home warm. At this event we will also have free giveaway products to help individuals to stay warm in their homes. Everyone is welcome to come along.

Community Cost of Living Grant (closes 31st March)

CnES, Third Sector Hebrides, TSI and Volunteering Scotland are working together to support people in the Western Isles who may be struggling financially due to the high cost of living. Grants up to £500 per household are available to help costs such as childcare, fuel for house and vehicles, essential travel and household repair costs. Application forms are available in the foyer of the Community Centre and at Forage (22 Kirkibost). If you would like help filling out forms, please get in touch with Joanna on 07771534048/ email:jo@greatbernera.org . This service is fully confidential.

RESEARCH REQUEST

Hello Bernera !!!

My name is Nancy McFarlane, and I'm a student in my final dissertation year with the OU.

I'm trying to get in touch with some participants who would be interested in taking part in a research project looking at the effects of Community Land buyouts on the residents of Scotland's islands.

I will be conducting short interviews (40 minutes) between 18th and 24th March, and I'm looking for a few residents over the age of 18 who would like to talk about their island's story.

If you would like to be a part of the project by adding your experience of how the island has changed under community ownership, please contact me at :

nancemcfarlane@hotmail.co.uk or on: **07557509862**.

LÀRAICHEAN EACHDRAIDHEIL



Saoilidh mi gu bheil mi air sgrìobhadh roimhe gu bheil ùidh mhòr agam ann an rudan eachdraidheil.

Ged as fhèarr leam caistean an gu mòr, is chaomh leam a h-uile seòrsa togalaich aosmhor, gu h-araid tobhtaichean, a leithid de taighean, eaglaisean, muilnean Lochlannach, tobraichean, eadhon àirighean, agus tha pailteas dhuibh air tìr-mòr agus anns na h- Eileanan.

Ach tha caraghan eile ann a tha a'tiort iongantach dhomh: na cearcallan cloiche agus na tursachan. Tha iad cho dìomhar agus sònriachte. Nam b'urrainn dhaibh bruidhinn, bhiodh mòran sgeulachdan inntinneach aca ri innse, oir chaidh iad a thogail timcheall air còig mìle bliadhna air ais anns an Linn Nuadh-chreagach.

Tha eòlaichean de'n bheachd gur e àiteachan adraidh, cruinneachaidhean sòisealta agus cladhan a bh'annta.

Bha cothrom agam tadhal air tòrr dhuibh ann an àiteachan eadar-dhealaichte, mar eisimpleir an Dà Abstol Dheug faisg air Dùn Phris, Cearcall a'Bhrodgar ann an Arcaibh nea Cearcall cloiche a'Glinne-gorm ann am

Muile, dìreach airson beagan ainmeachadh.

Cha do dhiochuimhnich mi ar Tursachan Chalanais ainmeil idir, neo Clach an Truseil, an tursa as àirde ann an Alba. Agus gu dearbh tha natursachan againn fhèin an seo ann am Beàrnaraigh.

Sgrìobhaidh mi a-nis rudeigin mu na ciad tursachan a chunnic mi: "Long Meg and her Daughters" faisg air Penrith ann an Sasainn.

Bha mi dà neo trì bliadhna a dh'aois nuair a chaidh mi ann còmhla ri mo theaghlach agus chan fhaca mi iad a-rithist gu faisg air trì fichead bliadhna às dèidh sin.

'S e tursa a th'ann an "Long Meg", deante de clach-ghainmhich ruadh agus tha i na seasamh ri taobh cearcall-cloiche nan clach-gràin: a Nigheanan.

A reir beul-aitris b'e buidheann bhana-bhuidseachan a bh'annta. Aon latha thionndaidh iad gu chloich thachair seo a chionn nach robh iad, a'cumail an t-Sàbaid. An àite sin bha iad a'dannsadh gu fiadhaich a-muigh air a'mhointich. Tha an uirsgeul cuideachd ag radh gu bheil draoidheachd air na clachan agus mar sin chan urrainn dhuibh gan cùntadh.

Ann an 1822 rinn Uileam Wordsworth neo-bhàsmhòr "Long Meg" ann an dàn àlainn.

Linne NicLeòid
Dun Innes



BIRDS

As Spring approaches, most of our natural world begins to burst into life, from the new green shoots on the heather, to the frog spawn appearing in our ditches. Most of the bird species found here also begin to think of new life. Pairings are formed, nest sites are visited and checked out, and soon egg laying will begin. It is therefore a good time of year to remind ourselves of the laws relating to our resident birds, as well as migratory species.

It is important to remember that all wild birds in Great Britain are protected under the Wildlife and Countryside Act 1981 (as amended). This means that it is an offence to intentionally, or recklessly, do or cause any of the following to any wild bird:

- kill, injure or take a bird
- take, damage, destroy or interfere with a nest of any bird while it is in use or being built
- obstruct or prevent any bird from using its nest
- take or destroy an egg of any bird

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(It is to be noted that there are certain exceptions, such as shooting within a set season, or for control of numbers, but for the vast majority of people and birds these laws apply)

In addition to these laws, further protection is given to some of the rarer species, as well as to those that are particularly vulnerable to disturbance and / or persecution. Schedule 1 birds include Golden Eagle, White-tailed Eagle, Merlin, Peregrine, Red Throated Diver, Greenshank, and Corncrake. For any of these, and any wild bird listed on Schedule 1, it is also an offence to disturb:

- any bird while it is building a nest
- any bird while it is in, on, or near a nest containing eggs or young
- any bird while lekking (a courtship display carried out by certain birds)
- the dependent young of any bird

Golden Eagles, White-tailed Eagles, Hen Harriers and Red Kite are also covered by further protection as schedule 1A birds, meaning that they may not be intentionally or recklessly harassed at any time, including outside of breeding. And A1 birds (Golden Eagles and White-tailed Eagles) are afforded even more protection meaning it is an offence to intentionally or recklessly take, damage, destroy or interfere with a nest habitually used by these birds at any time, not just during breeding season.

Whilst most people would, of course, never intentionally cause any of the above to happen, many will forget about the part of the law that covers the actions of recklessness. This may mean that those who allow their dogs to run free through an area used by ground nesting birds during nesting time, may "recklessly" cause damage to a nest. Standing too near a nest site of a Schedule 1 bird may recklessly cause it to be disturbed, in particular when the adult birds are attempting to return to a nest in order to feed young. Sharing the whereabouts of a Schedule 1A bird and / or its nest site, may recklessly cause it to be disturbed by those trying to get a closer look.

We are incredibly privileged to have such a wide variety of wild birds living and nesting here, in particular those covered by Schedule 1, but we need to work together to protect them from disturbance. If you know the whereabouts of a nest site please don't share it, especially by publishing the details online. If you want to observe these magnificent birds please do so from as far away as possible, and leave the moment you may be causing a disturbance to them. And finally, please keep dogs on a short lead in areas where ground nesting birds may be present, particularly during nesting time. At the least you may cause disturbance to a nest site, but with penalties including hefty fines and imprisonment, you may also find yourself on the wrong side of the law.



Sam Milns
Kirkibost

GENERAL KNOWLEDGE QUIZ

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| 1. A Shakespeare play and a cigar | 18. A team follower and a blower of cool air |
| 2. A cider and a prime minister | 19. The centre of a storm and for seeing |
| 3. A palace guard and a gin | 20. To jump out of a plane and a block of hay |
| 4. A biscuit and a flightless bird | 21. A work force and a political party |
| 5. A bay and a forest outlaw | 22. To alter something and a small amount of cashback |
| 6. Music and a drink | 23. To send a letter and an upright pole |
| 7. Sound of a bell and a payment | 24. To slide and a ladies under garment |
| 8. Part of a tree and a type of baggage | 25. Four wheeled bike and an open square at university |
| 9. Illegal loan person and a sea creature | 26. A high-ranking politician and a church leader |
| 10. A wee creature and a computer curser mover | 27. A TV receiver and a type of bombardment |
| 11. A colour and a fruit | 28. An amphibious vehicle and a water bird |
| 12. A set of numbers and a piece of furniture | 29. Star signs and a fast rubber boat |
| 13. To look at someone and tells the time | 30. A long seat and a panel of judges |
| 14. To run slowly and a memory aid | |
| 15. A person can be considered this and so can a drink | |
| 16. Road furniture and something of the times | |
| 17. A work period and a movement | |

Colin Halliday
Kirkibost



GRACE

We occupy a world where many people are encouraged to boast about their achievements. To succeed, one is taught that this is essential to promote oneself.

The story is told that at a reception honoring musician Sir Robert Mayer on his 100th birthday, an elderly British socialite Lady, Diana Cooper, enthusiastically conversed with a friendly woman who seemed to know her well. The Lady's failing eyesight prevented her from recognizing her fellow guest, until she peered more closely at the magnificent diamonds that adorned her neck. They were fabulous and danced continually, under the bright lights of the hall.

Only then did she realise that the person whom she had been talking to was none other, the later Queen Elizabeth 2! Overcome with embarrassment, Lady Diana curtsied and stammered, "Ma'am, oh, ma'am, I'm sorry ma'am. I didn't recognize you without your crown!" She immediately replied, "It was so much Sir Robert's evening, that I decided to leave it behind."

Power, fame, celebrity, riches do not bestow humility. Grace does!

Reminding us that an even greater Potentate than Queen Elizabeth, required to leave His crown and glory behind in Heaven, to save His people from their sins, as He ***'made Himself of no reputation, taking the form of a bondservant, and coming in the likeness of men. And being found in appearance as a man, He humbled Himself and became obedient to the point of death, even the death of the cross'***, Phil 2:7-8

Rev Hugh Maurice Stewart
Uig & Bernera



BERNERA BAKES...CUSTARD CREAM BLONDIES

Ingredients:

175g butter margarine
200g muscovado sugar light
125g caster sugar
4 tbsp custard powder
2 eggs
2 tsp vanilla extract
 Pinch salt
250g Self raising four (sifted)
150g white chocolate (chopped)
10 custard creams (chopped) for blondie.
 5 custard creams (chopped) for topping.



Method:

Melt butter/margarine, 2 sugars & custard powder in a large pan, heat until sugars have dissolved. Cool, add eggs and vanilla extract. Add four & salt. Add chopped custard creams & chocolate, mixing well. Add to baking tray (20x30cm), level, sprinkle chopped custard creams. Bake for 30mins @ 180 °C.

Careen MacLennan
Kirkibost

